

The Despairing Man

I walked to my home in the dark fog. It was the end of the day. I stumbled along and alone, as I had visited a bar that day. I had been fired from my work. My head ached as I moved: *crack... crack... crack!* Every movement I heard, every step increasing the lightning-bolts up and down my leg, my back, and into my mind.

Finally, I made it to my door. It was made of oak and was generally considered of good quality around where I lived. I was lucky, unlike most others. But I was not lucky that day.

My shaky hands opened the door, I walked inside, and my hall came blurringly into view. It was a miracle I found my way that night. The door closed behind me as I took one step, two steps, three steps up the stairs... and I crashed right back down.

I could not get back up. I was too tired. I felt useless. Perhaps I still am...
'No,' said the voice.

I look at my memory and then I look towards a bright, floating orb in front of me. From it came dazzling gems of fire, and within it were stars.

I move my eyes away, as the light is blinding.

I tell the orb, 'What do I have to offer to this world? There is nothing for me.'

And it replies, '*Do not despair. Is it not written that I have conquered death through death?*'

'I do not understand. I do not know you.'

'All things know me, even the devils know and shudder.'

‘Whoever you are, I cannot continue! I’m a disgrace. I have failed my family, myself, and *everybody*! I’m an outcast!’

And suddenly, I see a small light at the end of a tunnel. I walk toward it. The tunnel is made of brick and is a holdover of the colonial days of my town. Much of the homeless reside underneath it next to the river. It often flows and rushes quickly, making it a dangerous place to stay, but for a few weeks of the year, it is calm.

I know where I am.

Another me was walking down the tunnel as well. I was holding something, some food and drink. It was all I had for lunch that day. There was a homeless man sitting in the tunnel, cold. He was also wet. The memory-me was walking towards him and began to converse. I gave him my food and the man looked grateful. We were laughing about some joke I had made and he had gotten.

I wake up on the floor of my house, on top of the stairs. I stand up, quite shakily I must add, and I go to the door and open it. The mail had piled up for days. Nevertheless, I must continue.